

India-Vietnam Relations



For Prelims: Vision SAGAR , ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement , Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative , South China Sea , Mekong Ganga Cooperation , VINBAX .

For Mains: India-Vietnam relations and their role in India's Act East Policy, India's engagement with ASEAN

Source: PIB

Why in News?

The President of Vietnam concluded a State Visit to India, coinciding with the 10 th anniversary of the establishment of the **Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in 2016**.

- The visit marked a significant moment in bilateral relations, with India reaffirming Vietnam as a key pillar of its **Act East Policy** and **Vision SAGAR (Security and Growth for All in the Region)**.

Summary

- India and Vietnam upgraded their ties to an **Enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership** , expanding cooperation in defence, trade, digital payments, rare earth minerals, and Indo-Pacific maritime security.
- The visit reinforced Vietnam's importance in India's **Act East Policy** and **Vision SAGAR** , while both countries committed to strengthening regional connectivity, resilient supply chains, and a rules-based Indo-Pacific order.

What are the Key Highlights of the State Visit?

- **Elevation of Bilateral Ties:** The relationship has been officially upgraded to an "**Enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership**."
 - This is the third major elevation in less than two decades (following the **Strategic Partnership in 2007** and **Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in 2016**).
- **Economic and Trade Cooperation** : Both nations set an ambitious bilateral trade goal of **USD 25**

billion by 2030 .

- Both sides agreed to accelerate the review and updating of the **ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement (AITIGA)** by the end of 2026 to ensure resilient regional supply chains.
- **Defense and Maritime Security:** Vietnam formally joined India's **Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative (IPOI)** , signaling a deep alignment in ensuring a free, open, and rules-based Indo-Pacific.
 - The leaders committed to expanding defense procurement. India offered **Maintenance, Repair, and Overhaul (MRO)** support for Vietnam's military platforms, including **Su-30 fighter jets and Kilo-class submarines**.
 - Without explicitly naming China, both nations emphasized the importance of freedom of navigation, peaceful resolution of disputes under **UNCLOS (1982)**, and the swift conclusion of a binding Code of Conduct (CoC) in the **South China Sea (SCS)**.
- **Rare Earths and Critical Minerals:** To break the geopolitical monopoly on **critical minerals**, a crucial MoU was signed between IREL (India) Ltd. and the Institute for Technology of Radioactive and Rare Elements (ITRRE) of Vietnam.
 - This formalizes cooperation in the extraction and processing of **rare earth elements**, vital for clean energy, defense electronics, and advanced manufacturing.
- **Digital Connectivity and Financial Innovation:** An MoU between NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL) and Vietnam's NAPAS was signed to enable **Cross-Border QR code interoperability for seamless digital payments**.
 - The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** and the State Bank of Vietnam (SBV) established a framework to collaborate on digital financial innovation.
- **Healthcare and Pharmaceuticals:** An agreement between **India's Central Drugs Standard Control Organization (CDSCO)** and the Drug Administration of Vietnam (DAV) was signed.
 - This will ease regulatory bottlenecks and significantly improve market access for Indian pharmaceutical products in Vietnam.
- **Audit and Governance:** The **Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) of India** renewed cooperation with Vietnam's State Audit Office to enhance transparency in **public sector auditing** .
- **Agriculture and Tourism:** Market access was granted for **Indian grapes to Vietnam and Vietnamese Durian to India** , alongside a new five-year **Cultural Exchange Programme (2026-30)** .
- **Culture and Educational Cooperation:** Both countries renewed cultural ties through a **Cultural Exchange Programme (2026-2030)** and signed multiple MoUs to establish **Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) Chairs of Indian Studies in Vietnamese universities**, promoting academic exchange and cultural diplomacy.
 - Another agreement focused on the **digitisation, conservation, and online dissemination of Cham manuscripts of Indian origin** preserved in Vietnam.



How are India-Vietnam Relations?

- **Trade and Economy:** Bilateral trade crossed **USD 16 billion in 2025-26** , with India exporting engineering and pharmaceutical goods while importing electronics and machinery.
- **Defense Partnership:** Guided by the **Joint Vision Statement 2030** and a **Mutual Logistics Support MoU** , defense ties include the gifting of the missile corvette **INS Kirpan** to Vietnam and the conduct of the bilateral peacekeeping exercise **VINBAX** .
- **Development Cooperation:** India provides assistance through **Quick Impact Projects (QIPs)** under the **Mekong Ganga Cooperation (MGC)** framework and has restoration projects led by the **Archaeological Survey of India (ASI)** at the **UNESCO World Heritage site of My Son** .
- **Humanitarian Assistance:** India launched **Operation Sadbhav** in September 2024 to deliver emergency relief supplies to Vietnam following the devastation caused by **Typhoon Yagi** .
- **Geopolitical Alignment:** Both nations share a vision for a "**Free, Open, and Rules-based Indo-Pacific** " highlight a shared commitment to maritime security and the **1982 UNCLOS** framework.

Why is Vietnam Strategically Important to India?

- **Geopolitical Fulcrum:** Vietnam is strategically located in the **South China Sea**, a critical maritime route where over 50% of India's trade passes.
 - Vietnam's resistance to regional hegemony makes it a natural partner for India in maintaining a multipolar Asia.
- **Economic Diversification:** As global supply chains adopt a "**China-Plus-One**" strategy, Vietnam has emerged as a major manufacturing hub.
 - Closer integration allows Indian industries to plug into broader ASEAN and global value chains.
- **Energy Security:** ONGC Videsh Limited (OVL) has historical and ongoing investments in oil and gas exploration blocks in **Vietnam's Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ)** , which are critical for India's energy security despite external geopolitical pressures.
- **Counter-Terrorism:** Vietnam's strong condemnation of cross-border terrorism (including the recent

What are the Major Challenges in India-Vietnam Relations?

- **Vietnam's "Four Noes" Policy:** Vietnam adheres to a strict defense policy— **no military alliances, no siding with one country against another, no foreign military bases, and no using force in international relations**. This limits the depth of actual military interoperability with India.
- **Economic Asymmetry and Trade Deficit:** The **trade deficit is heavily in favor of Vietnam** . India primarily exports raw materials and bovine meat while importing high-value electronic goods and machinery.
- **Physical Connectivity:** The [India-Myanmar-Thailand \(IMT\) Trilateral Highway](#) , which is intended to provide a land bridge to Vietnam, has faced persistent delays due to the political instability in Myanmar and funding issues.
 - There is still a lack of direct, high-frequency **shipping routes** between major Indian ports and Vietnamese ports like Haiphong, making trade more expensive and time-consuming.
- **Implementation Lags in Defense Cooperation:** India has extended several **Lines of Credit (LoC)** for defense procurement (including the USD 500 million LoC), but the actual drawdown and implementation of projects have been slow due to bureaucratic bottlenecks in both Hanoi and New Delhi.
- **Divergent Multilateral Priorities:** While Vietnam is a key pillar of India's **Act East Policy** , ASEAN as a whole is often divided on how to handle the **Indo-Pacific** and the [Quadrilateral Security Dialogue \(QUAD\)](#) , which can sometimes dilute bilateral initiatives.

What Steps can Enhance India-Vietnam Relations?

- **Defence Co-production and Export:** Expedite the transfer of the [BrahMos supersonic cruise missile system](#) and fully utilize the existing Lines of Credit (LoC) to provide **Made-in-India defence platforms** (patrol vessels, radars).
 - This will help reduce Vietnam's historical dependence on Russian military hardware and solidify India as a Net Security Provider.
- **Correcting the Trade Deficit:** To achieve the ambitious **USD 25 billion trade target by 2030** , India must push for the removal of non-tariff barriers and fast-track the review of the **ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement (AITIGA)** , while aggressively promoting its IT, FinTech, and Pharmaceutical services in Vietnam.
- **Securing Critical Supply Chains:** Rapidly execute the MoU on **Rare Earth Elements (REE)** to build supply chain resilience for clean energy and defence electronics, strategically breaking the current geopolitical monopoly in critical minerals.
- **Scaling Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI):** Broaden the **UPI-NAPAS (QR code interoperability)** linkage to create a robust "digital corridor." This will facilitate seamless cross-border e-commerce and tourism, serving as a successful template for broader ASEAN digital integration.

Conclusion

The 2026 State Visit underscores a transition from symbolic historical ties to highly functional,

security-oriented cooperation. By integrating defense support, digital interoperability, and critical mineral supply chains, the India-Vietnam Enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership is poised to act as a stabilizing force in the Indo-Pacific architecture.

Drishti Mains Question:

India-Vietnam relations have moved from symbolism to strategic functionality. Discuss.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is the latest status of India-Vietnam relations?

India and Vietnam have upgraded ties to an **Enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership**, deepening cooperation in defence, trade, digital finance, and critical minerals.

2. What is the trade target set by India and Vietnam?

Both countries have set a target of **USD 25 billion bilateral trade by 2030** and are working to update **AITIGA by end-2026**.

3. Why is Vietnam strategically important to India?

Vietnam is vital for India's **South China Sea strategy, ASEAN outreach, energy security, and Indo-Pacific maritime balance**.

4. What are the key new areas of cooperation?

Major new areas include **rare earths, cross-border QR payments, pharmaceuticals, defence support, and audit cooperation**.

5. What are the main challenges in India-Vietnam ties?

The main challenges are **Vietnam's Four Noes policy, trade deficit, connectivity gaps, defence implementation delays, and ASEAN divisions**.

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UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Q. In the Mekong-Ganga Cooperation, an initiative of six countries, which of the following is/are not a participant/ participants?(2015)

1. Bangladesh
2. Cambodia
3. China
4. Myanmar
5. Thailand

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2, 3 and 4
(c) 1 and 3
(d) 1, 2 and 5

Ans: (c)

Q. Consider the following pairs:(2020)

	River	Flows into
1.	Mekong	Andaman Sea
2.	Thames	Irish Sea
3.	Volga	Caspian Sea
4.	Zambezi	Indian Ocean

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 3 only
(c) 3 and 4 only
(d) 1, 2 and 4 only

Ans: (c)

NCRB's Crime in India 2024 Report



For Prelims: National Crime Records Bureau , Digital Arrest , Deepfakes , Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre ,

For Mains: Cybercrime in India: causes, trends, and institutional gaps, NCRB and its policy significance.

Source:TH

Why in News?

The **National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)** released the '**Crime in India - 2024**' report . While the data shows an **overall 6% decline in cognisable crimes across the country** , it highlights a stark **17% surge in cybercrimes** , reflecting a rapid transition from traditional physical offences to sophisticated borderless digital crimes.

- The NCRB also released the **Accidental Deaths & Suicides in India (ADSI) 2024 report**, according to which 1,70,746 suicides were recorded in 2024. Deaths due to drug overdose saw a **50% increase in 2024 compared with 2023**.

Summary

- The NCRB 2024 report recorded a decline in overall cognisable crimes, but this was partly due to legal changes under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, while crimes against children, senior citizens, and economic offences continued to rise.
- Cybercrime emerged as the biggest concern, increasing by 17% due to AI-enabled frauds, digital arrest scams, weak digital literacy, and organised cyber syndicates, highlighting the urgent need for stronger cyber governance and digital security reforms.

What are the Key Findings of the NCRB 2024 Report?

- **Total Cases:** India recorded **58.85 lakh cognisable crimes** in 2024, down from 62.41 lakh in 2023.
 - The reported 6% dip is largely attributed to the implementation of the **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023**.
 - Under the BNS, simple '**Hurt**' was made a non-cognisable offence. Consequently, cases registered under the 'Hurt' category saw a massive **30.58% decline** (dropping from 6.36 lakh to 4.41 lakh cases), **which artificially deflated the overall national crime numbers**.
- **Crime Rate:** The Crime rate, which is a measure of cases registered per lakh population, saw a dip from **448.3 in 2023 to 418.9 in 2024** , the lowest since 2019.
- **Trends in Crimes:**
 - **Murder and Kidnapping:** Murder cases witnessed a marginal decline of 2.4%, with 'disputes' remaining the leading motive. Kidnapping and abduction cases declined by a significant 15.4%.
 - **Property Offences:** Traditional property offences like theft (down 9.8%) and robbery (down 13%)

saw a noticeable decline, though burglary remained relatively stagnant.

- **Crimes Against Vulnerable Sections:**

- **Children:** Crime against children increased by 5.9% in 2024. Kidnapping and abduction accounted for the highest share, followed by **POCSO** -related offences, while the **crime rate rose to 42.3 per lakh children population (39.9 in 2023)**.
- **Women:** Crimes against women declined by 1.5%, with 4.41 lakh cases reported in 2024 compared to 4.48 in 2023.
 - However, the crime rate remains high at 64.6 per lakh female population (66.2 in 2023), with **'Cruelty by husband or his relatives'** remaining the dominant offence.
- **Marginalised Communities:** Crimes against **Scheduled Castes (SCs)** decreased by 3.6%, while crimes against **Scheduled Tribes (STs)** showed a sharp decline of **23.1% over 2023**.
- **Senior Citizens:** Crimes against senior citizens rose by 16.9% in 2024. Theft accounted for the highest share, followed by **forgery, cheating and fraud (FCF)**, and murder.
- **Juveniles in Conflict with Law** : Cases registered against Juveniles in Conflict with Law increased by 11.2%.
- **Human Trafficking and Missing Persons:** Human trafficking cases declined slightly in 2024, though over 6,000 victims, including many children, were reported trafficked, with authorities rescuing thousands and arresting offenders.
 - Meanwhile, **missing person cases increased by 7.3%, while missing children cases rose by 7.8%**, highlighting persistent concerns over trafficking, child safety, and vulnerable populations.
- **Economic Offences:** Increased by 4.6% in 2024, with forgery, cheating, and fraud (FCF) accounting for the majority of cases.
 - Meanwhile, the **Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988** cases registered by the State Anti-Corruption Bureau remained largely stable, with most involving trap cases.
- **Environment Related Offences:** Declined by 16.4% in 2024, with most cases registered under the **Cigarettes and Other Tobacco Products Act (COTPA), 2003**, followed by **Noise Pollution Acts**.
- **State-Wise Variations:** **Telangana** recorded a sharp rise in total cognisable crimes in 2024 and emerged among States with the highest crime rates (cases per lakh population) in the country.
 - **Uttar Pradesh** recorded the highest per capita crime rate (7.4), followed by Arunachal Pradesh and Jharkhand.
 - **Nagaland** continued to record the **lowest crime rate in the country**.
 - The State/UT reporting highest Charge-sheeting Rate under IPC and BNS Crimes are Kerala (94.5%), Puducherry (91.0%) and West Bengal (90.6%).
 - Among metropolitan cities, **Delhi** ranked worst in violent crimes (murders, kidnappings) and fourth worst in economic offences. Bengaluru has recorded the country's **highest suicide rate (20 per lakh population) among major metros**.

Cybercrime Epidemic

- The most alarming takeaway from the 2024 report is the unabated rise of digital offences, which grew by **17%** to cross **1.01 lakh reported cases**.
 - **The crime rate under this category increased from 6.2 in 2023 to 7.3 in 2024.**
- **Rise of the 'Digital Arrest':** A major new trend in 2024 was the exponential spike in **'Digital Arrest'** frauds. Scammers posing as law enforcement agencies (CBI, Customs, or Police) coerce victims over video calls, threatening them with immediate incarceration to extort their life savings.

- **Dominant Motives: Fraud** remains the overwhelming motive for cybercrime (over 70%), driven by **AI-enabled phishing, voice cloning, and sophisticated** investment scams, followed by sexual exploitation and extortion.
- **State Hubs:** States with high IT penetration, such as **Telangana**, recorded the highest cybercrime rate, with over 70 cases per lakh population, followed by Karnataka and Maharashtra.
 - These states continue to report the highest volumes of cybercrime, though authorities note significant under-reporting in rural and tier-3 areas.

What is Driving the Surge in Cybercrime in India?

- **Weaponization of Artificial Intelligence:** Cybercriminals are leveraging generative AI to execute **hyper-personalized phishing, deepfakes (cognitive warfare), and automated "zero-day" exploits** at machine speed, bypassing traditional security barriers.
- **Expansion of the Digital Attack Surface:** The massive success of India's **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)** has outpaced the implementation of robust "Zero Trust" security architectures, making the **financial sector highly lucrative for scammers**.
- **The "Human Firewall" Deficit:** A significant lack of digital literacy (only 38% of India households are digitally literate (61% in urban areas and 25% in rural areas)) among new internet users has led to the proliferation of social engineering crimes.
- **Institutionalised Cyber-Fraud Syndicates:** Cybercrime has evolved from isolated, individual acts to highly organized, institutionalized operations originating from regional hotspots (e.g., Mewat, Jamtara).
 - These syndicates exploit vast networks of **mule bank accounts and forged SIM cards** to siphon funds.
- **Targeting of Critical Information Infrastructure:** There is a growing vulnerability in critical sectors like **healthcare, power grids, and telecommunications** .
 - The **Election Commission of India** stated that over **68 lakh cyberattack attempts from India and abroad** targeted key election platforms, including the results portal, during vote counting for the Assembly elections in five States and one Union Territory.
 - Cloud misconfigurations, inadequate supply-chain security, and poorly secured IoT (**Internet of Things**) devices provide easy gateways for large-scale disruptions.
- **Capacity and Jurisdictional Hurdles:** Since "Police" is a State subject in India, varying levels of training and cyber capabilities among State police forces often create fragmented responses to borderless digital crimes and cyber threats.
 - Despite initiatives like the **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)** , local law enforcement faces a severe shortage of **cyber-forensics capabilities and Red Teaming (ethical hacking) professionals** , resulting in heavy investigative backlogs.
- **State-Sponsored Cyber Warfare:** Amid growing global geopolitical volatility, there is a rising threat from a **dvanced persistent threats (APTs)** and state-sponsored cyberattacks originating from hostile nations.
 - Such threats could become more dangerous if advanced **AI-driven cyber tools like Mythos** fall into the wrong hands, potentially enabling large-scale theft of sensitive data and undermining India's digital sovereignty.
- **Cross-Border Criminal Networks:** A significant portion of financial frauds is orchestrated from regions outside India's direct law enforcement jurisdiction (e.g., Southeast Asian scam compounds), complicating the tracing and recovery of siphoned funds.

How Can India Strengthen Its Cybercrime Governance and Digital Security Framework?

- **Structural & Administrative Reforms (From Silos to Systems):**

- **Dedicated Cyber Cadre:** Move beyond the current "generalist" police model by creating a **specialised Cyber-cadre** within State Police and Central Agencies, utilizing **lateral entry for tech-experts** in forensic accounting and ethical hacking.
- **Strengthening I4C:** Elevate the **I4C** into a statutory National Agency to facilitate **seamless inter-state coordination** and resolve jurisdictional deadlocks in "borderless" crimes.

- **Legal & Procedural Fortification (Rule of Law in Bitspace):**

- **Evidence Standardisation:** Under the **Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam (BSA), 2023** streamline the protocols for the **collection and preservation of digital evidence** to prevent the high rate of acquittals caused by procedural lapses.
- **Aggressive Enforcement of DPDP Act:** Leverage the **Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023**, to hold financial institutions and social media intermediaries accountable for data breaches that facilitate **"Digital Arrest" and social engineering scams**.

- **Technological Intervention (Fighting Code with Code):**

- **AI-led Predictive Policing:** Deploy AI-driven **National Cybercrime Threat Analytics** to identify high-risk digital signatures and dismantle **fraud-hubs (e.g., Jamtara/Mewat)** through real-time monitoring of **"Mule Accounts" and Voice over Internet Protocol (VoIP) traffic**.
- **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) Security:** Integrate **"Security by Design"** into India's DPI (UPI, Aadhaar) by adopting **Zero-Trust Architectures** to protect the financial pipeline from sophisticated phishing.

- **Social Justice & The "Human Firewall":**

- **Vulnerability Mapping:** Implement a **"Senior Citizen Security Grid"** at the police-station level to address the **16.9% spike in crimes against the elderly**, focusing on financial literacy and doorstep safety audits.
- **Behavioural Nudges:** Launch a **National Digital Hygiene Mission** using Nudge Theory to educate citizens on "Digital Arrests," turning the population into a **"Human Firewall"** against social engineering.

- **Cyber-Diplomacy & International Cooperation:**

- **Global Intelligence Sharing:** India must lead the push for a **UN-backed Global Convention on Cybercrime** to ensure swift **extradition and fund repatriation**.

National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)

- **Establishment:** NCRB was founded in **1986** , based on the recommendations of the **Tandon Committee (1974), National Police Commission (1977-1981) and the MHA's Task Force (1985)**.
 - It operates under the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA), Government of India** , with its headquarters located in **New Delhi** .
- **Core Mandate:** To function as a national clearing house and repository of information on crime and criminals, assisting law enforcement agencies in linking crimes to their perpetrators.
- **Major Publications:** The NCRB publishes highly authoritative annual reports that serve as the baseline for policy-making and judicial review in India. The three major ones are:
 - **Crime in India** (Comprehensive crime statistics)
 - **Accidental Deaths & Suicides in India (ADSI)**
 - **Prison Statistics India**
- **Key Technological Initiatives:**
 - **CCTNS (Crime and Criminal Tracking Network & Systems):** A nationwide digital network connecting over 15,000 police stations for real-time sharing of FIRs and investigation data.
 - **NAFIS (National Automated Fingerprint Identification System):** A centralized, searchable database assigning a unique 10-digit lifetime ID to arrested individuals based on their fingerprints.
 - **NDSO (National Database of Sexual Offenders):** A central registry for tracking convicted sexual offenders across the country.

Conclusion

The NCRB 2024 report serves as a wake-up call. The challenges have fundamentally shifted from **"managing physical law and order"** to **"securing the digital frontier."** Overcoming these hurdles requires a pivot from reactive beat-policing to proactive, intelligence-driven cyber policing, backed by massive investments in **district-level forensic laboratories**.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is the main takeaway of the NCRB 2024 report?

The report shows an overall decline in cognisable crimes, but cybercrime rose sharply, showing a shift from physical offences to borderless digital crime.

2. What is a “Digital Arrest” scam?

It is a cyber fraud where criminals impersonate CBI, police, or customs officials on video calls and threaten arrest to extort money.

3. Why is cybercrime increasing in India?

Major reasons include AI-enabled phishing, weak digital literacy, expansion of DPI, organised fraud syndicates, and fragmented policing capacity.

4. What reforms are suggested to control cybercrime?

The article suggests a specialised cyber cadre, a stronger I4C, better digital evidence handling, strict DPDP enforcement, AI-led monitoring, and Zero Trust security for DPI.

5. What is NCRB’s role in crime governance?

NCRB acts as a national repository of crime data and publishes key reports like Crime in India, ADSI, and Prison Statistics India, which support policy and law enforcement.

[Watch Video on YouTube:

▶ <https://www.youtube.com/embed/m57ZRh614hA>

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UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Prelims

Q.1 In India, under cyber insurance for individuals, which of the following benefits are generally covered, in addition to payment for the loss of funds and other benefits? (2020)

1. Cost of restoration of the computer system in case of malware disrupting access to one's computer
2. Cost of a new computer if some miscreant wilfully damages it, if proved so
3. Cost of hiring a specialised consultant to minimise the loss in case of cyber extortion
4. Cost of defence in the Court of Law if any third party files a suit

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 4 only
- (b) 1, 3 and 4 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans: (b)

Q.2 In India, it is legally mandatory for which of the following to report on cyber security incidents? (2017)

1. Service providers
2. Data centres
3. Body corporate

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans: (d)

Mains

Q. What are the different elements of cyber security ? Keeping in view the challenges in cyber security, examine the extent to which India has successfully developed a comprehensive National Cyber Security Strategy. **(2022)**

Localized Climate Governance



Source: TH

Why in News?

India is witnessing a significant evolution in climate governance as states transition from generic, top-down **State Action Plans on Climate Change (SAPCCs)** to localized, data-driven strategies like the **Urban Heat Island (UHI)** mitigation efforts.

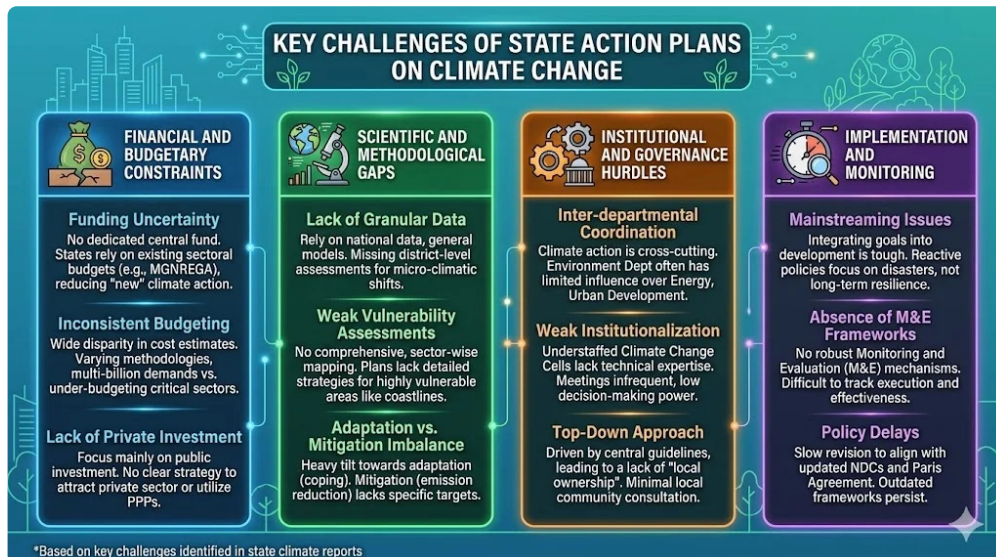
What Steps Have Been Taken for Localized Climate Governance?

- **Innovative Climate Financing:** Indian states are institutionalizing climate action through targeted initiatives, such as **Odisha's precise climate budgeting** , **Kerala** 's advanced disaster management, and **Madhya Pradesh** 's centralized climate knowledge platform.
 - In 2024, **Tamil Nadu** established the **Tamil Nadu Green Climate Company (TNGCC)** as a nodal agency for all climate action with a target of Rs 1,000-crore corpus.
- **Localized Heat Mitigation:** Cities like Chennai are targeting specific hotspots to counter the **Urban Heat Island** effect using **passive cooling** , mechanical ventilation, and operational advisories.
- **Institutional Accountability:** States are adopting "responsibility matrices" (e.g., Thane's heat task force) and requiring environment departments to present **annual progress reports to State Assemblies** to ensure on-ground action.
- **Data-Driven Policy:** The **Revamped Distribution Sector Scheme** portal enhances power distribution efficiency by providing **state-wise data** on **infrastructure upgrades** and **loss reduction** to guide funding priorities.
 - The **PM Surya Ghar** portal tracks **rooftop solar adoption** across states, offering public data that helps policymakers pinpoint regional gaps and refine uptake strategies.
- **Regulatory Shift:** The **16 th Finance Commission** 's recommendation to make **heatwaves** a **nationally notified disaster** is expected to unlock significant federal funding for city-level resilience.

What are State Action Plans on Climate Change?

- **About:** SAPCC is a policy framework designed by individual states and union territories in India to address challenges posed by **climate change** at a regional level. SAPCCs allow for "**sub-national**" **tailoring** to meet specific geographic, social, and economic needs.
- **Origin:** The SAPCCs were born out of India's **National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC)** , launched in **2008** . Recognizing that climate impacts (like **floods** , heatwaves, or **droughts**) vary significantly between a coastal state like Odisha and a mountainous state like Himachal Pradesh, the central government directed states to create their own **localized strategies** .
- **Key Objectives:** They prioritize **adaptation** strategies for community resilience alongside **mitigation** efforts, such as **renewable energy** and **waste management** , to reduce **greenhouse gas emissions** .

- **Common Focal Sectors:** While each state prioritizes different areas, most SAPCCs focus on these core sectors:
 - **Agriculture:** Developing **climate-resilient crops** and improving irrigation efficiency.
 - **Water Resources:** Focusing on rainwater harvesting and groundwater recharge.
 - **Forests & Biodiversity:** Increasing green cover to act as **carbon sinks** and protecting local ecosystems.
 - **Health:** Monitoring and managing the spread of heat-related illnesses and **vector-borne diseases**.
 - **Urban Habitat:** Promoting energy-efficient buildings and sustainable public transport.



Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is SAPCC?

SAPCC (State Action Plan on Climate Change) is a state-level policy framework to address climate adaptation and mitigation aligned with national goals.

2. What are examples of innovative climate financing by states?

Tamil Nadu established a nodal agency with a Rs 1,000-crore corpus, while Odisha implemented precise, trackable climate budgeting.

3. Which core sectors do SAPCCs typically prioritize?

Most plans focus on agriculture, water resources, forests, health, and urban habitats to build community resilience and reduce emissions.

[Watch Video on YouTube: ▶ <https://www.youtube.com/embed/hph4HFrV1gM>]

UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Q. With reference to the Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Limited (IREDA), which of the following statements is/are correct? (2015)

1. It is a Public Limited Government Company.
2. It is a Non-Banking Financial Company.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans: (c)

Q. With reference to the Agreement at the UNFCCC Meeting in Paris in 2015, which of the following statements is/are correct? (2016)

1. The Agreement was signed by all the member countries of the UN, and it will go into effect in 2017.
2. The Agreement aims to limit greenhouse gas emissions so that the rise in average global temperature by the end of this century does not exceed 2°C or even 1.5°C above pre-industrial levels.
3. Developed countries acknowledged their historical responsibility in global warming and committed to donate \$ 1000 billion a year from 2020 to help developing countries to cope with climate change.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans: (b)

India to Host 1st International Big Cat Summit



Source: TH

Recently, India announced that it will host the **1 st International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) Summit in New Delhi from 1 st - 2 nd June, 2026 .**

- **Delhi Declaration:** The summit is expected to adopt the ‘**Delhi Declaration**’, the first global declaration on big cat conservation, aimed at promoting shared priorities, transboundary cooperation, and a landscape-based approach for protecting big cats and their habitats.
- **Theme:** The summit will be guided by the theme — “**Save Big Cats, Save Humanity, Save Ecosystem.**”

IBCA

- **Origins:** IBCA was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in 2023 during the 50 th anniversary of **Project Tiger**, and was formally approved by the Union Cabinet in February 2024.
- **Implementation:** IBCA was established through the **National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA)** under the **Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change (MoEFCC)**.
 - It functions as a global platform to **share conservation expertise, fund conservation initiatives, and create a repository of technical knowledge** .
- **Objective:** The initiative’s main objective is the **conservation of seven major big cat species: the Tiger , Lion , Leopard , Snow Leopard , Cheetah , Jaguar , and Puma.**
- **Membership:** The Republic of Nicaragua, Kingdom of Eswatini, Republic of India, Federal Republic of Somalia, and Republic of Liberia have **ratified the IBCA framework agreement.**
 - **Membership is open to all United Nations member states**, including range countries where these species naturally occur and non-range countries interested in supporting big cat conservation.
- **Need for IBCA: Big Cats are under threat** due to **habitat loss, poaching , climate change , and human-wildlife conflicts** .
 - Conservation at a **global scale** is required to **halt population decline and reverse negative trends** .
- **Funding:** India has committed Rs. 150 crore (2023-2028) in support to the IBCA and is exploring additional funding through bilateral, multilateral, and donor organizations.

INTERNATIONAL BIG CAT ALLIANCE

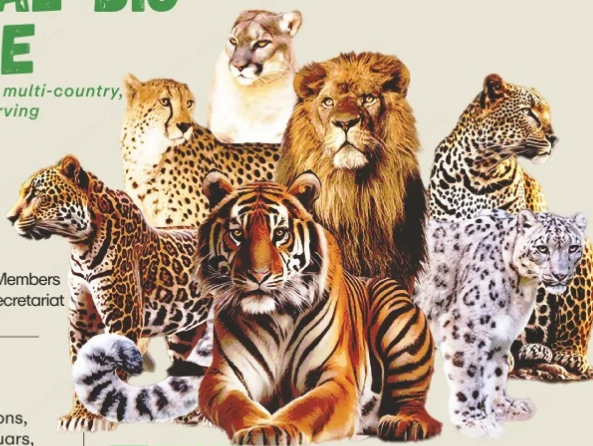
The International Big Cat Alliance is a multi-country, multi-agency coalition aimed at conserving big cat species and their habitats.

Launched by
India (2023)

Headquarters
India

Member states
96 countries

Structure
Consists of Assembly of Members
Standing Committee & Secretariat



FUNCTIONS

- Secure the future of big cats (Tigers, Lions, Leopards, Snow Leopards, Pumas, Jaguars, and Cheetahs)
- Mitigate the adverse effects of climate change
- Advocate for policy initiatives
- Attain the United Nations-mandated Sustainable Development Goals

THREATS TO BIG CATS

- Poaching
- Habitat loss & fragmentation
- Human-Leopard conflict
- Climate change & Deforestation

Conservation Status of Big Cats

Species	Scientific Name	IUCN Red List	CITES	Indian Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972
Tigers	<i>Panthera tigris</i>	Endangered	Appendix-I	Schedule-I
Lions	<i>Panthera leo</i>	Vulnerable	Appendix-I	Schedule-I
Leopards	<i>Panthera pardus</i>	Vulnerable	Appendix-I	Schedule-I
Snow Leopards	<i>Panthera uncia</i>	Vulnerable	Appendix-I	Schedule-I
Pumas	<i>Puma concolor</i>	Least Concerned	Appendix II (P. c. Costaricensis and cougar: Appendix-I)	NA
Jaguars	<i>Panthera onca</i>	Near Threatened	Appendix-I	NA
Cheetahs	<i>Acinonyx jubatus</i>	Vulnerable	Appendix-I	Schedule-I

Other Conservation Efforts in India

- Project Tiger (1973)
- Project Snow Leopard (2009)
- Asiatic Lion Reintroduction Project (2004)
- Project Cheetah (2022)



Read more: [International Big Cat Alliance](#)

2 New Semiconductor Units Approved in Gujarat Under ISM

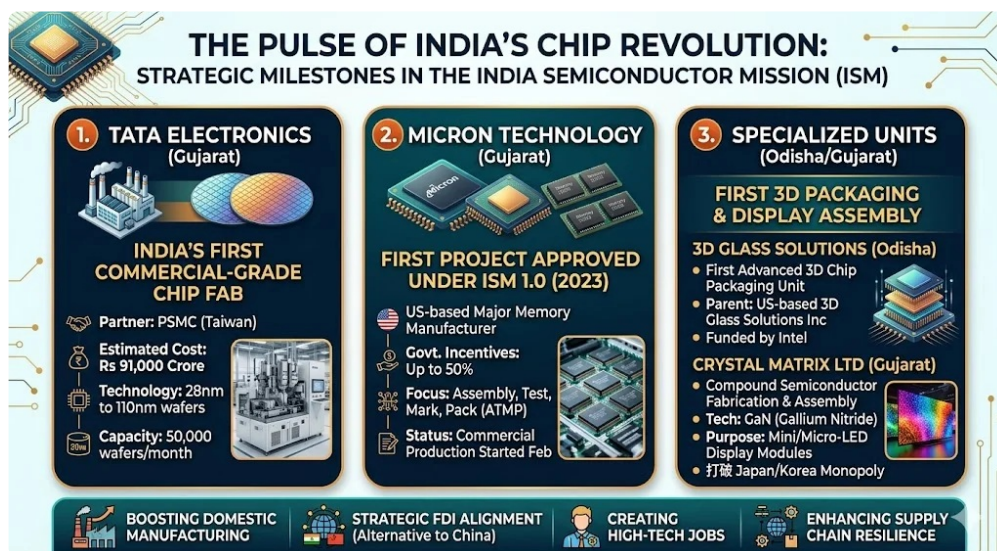


Source: IE

The Union Cabinet approved **two new semiconductor projects** under the **India Semiconductor**

Mission (ISM) , including **India's first commercial GaN-based Mini/Micro-LED display facility** and a semiconductor packaging unit, both to be established in **Gujarat**.

- With the approval of these projects, the total number of semiconductor plants under the ISM has increased to **12** , with facilities being established across Gujarat, Assam, Andhra Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, and Odisha.
- **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 1.0** : Launched in **2021** with **Rs 76,000 crore outlay** to build a **full-stack chip ecosystem** (fabrication, packaging, design, display manufacturing). 12 chip plants approved across **Gujarat, Assam, Andhra Pradesh, UP, Odisha, and Punjab** .
- **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0** : **ISM 2.0** (announced in **Union Budget 2026-27**) evolves from mere manufacturing subsidies to a **USD 11 billion** strategy targeting **ecosystem localisation** and indigenous design. It prioritises building a "**full-stack**" **industry** by supporting ancillary sectors like **chemicals** and **capital goods** .
- **Geopolitical and Economic Significance**: Semiconductors are now categorized as a **critical resource** ; localizing their production is essential for **deepening domestic value addition** in electronics and securing supply chains against global geopolitical tensions.



SEMICONDUCTORS

Semiconductors are materials having conductivity between conductors and insulators



- EXAMPLES**
 - **Pure Elements:** Silicon and Germanium
 - **Compounds:** Gallium Arsenide and Cadmium selenide
- SIGNIFICANCE**
 - Essential to almost all sectors of the economy – **aerospace, automobiles, communications, clean energy, information technology** and **medical devices** etc.
- SEMICONDUCTORS AND INDIA**
 - **India Imports from:** China, Taiwan, USA and Japan
 - **Indian Semiconductor Market:** Expected to reach **USD 55 bn** by **2026**

SCHEMES	OBJECTIVES
↳ Production-Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme ↳ Design Linked Incentive (DLI) Scheme ↳ Scheme for Promotion of Manufacturing of Electronic Components and Semi-conductors (SPECs)	↳ Encourage semiconductor and display manufacturing in the country. ↳ Nurture >20 domestic companies in semiconductor design Achieve a turnover of > Rs.1500 crore in next 5 years ↳ Manufacture electronics components and semiconductors

INDIA'S SEMICONDUCTOR MISSION (ISM)

VISION • Build a vibrant semiconductor and display design and innovation ecosystem	COMPONENTS • Scheme for setting up of Semiconductor Fabs • Scheme for setting up of Display Fabs • Scheme for setting up of Compound Semiconductors/Silicon Photonics/Sensors (including MEMS) Fabs/ Discrete Semiconductors Fab and Semiconductor ATMP/OSAT • DLI Scheme 
LAUNCHED • 2021	
NODAL MINISTRY • Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)	
TOTAL FINANCIAL OUTLAY • Rs 76,000 crore	

Read More: [India Semiconductor Mission 2.0](#)

Andaman & Nicobar Islands Set Guinness World Records



Source: TH

The **Andaman and Nicobar Islands** recently hosted **two unique underwater world records at Swaraj Dweep (Havelock Island)** to promote eco-tourism and establish the islands as a prime adventure destination.

- The events included the "**Largest Flag Unfurled Underwater**" near Radha Nagar Beach, where a 60m

x 40m Indian flag was unfurled, and the " **Tallest Human Stack Underwater**" near the lighthouse area, where divers formed a 10-meter-high stack, both aiming to set new world records.

Andaman and Nicobar Islands

- The Andaman and Nicobar Islands are a Union Territory of India comprising 836 islands, islets, and rocks located in the **Bay of Bengal** , with **Port Blair as its capital**.
 - **Swaraj Dweep** , formerly known as **Havelock Island** , is part of the **Ritchie's Archipelago** in the Andaman Islands.
 - It was **renamed in 2018** to honour India's freedom struggle and national identity.
- The **Ten Degree Channel**, located near the 10° north latitude, separates the Andaman Islands from the Nicobar Islands.
- Great Nicobar Island is the largest island in the Nicobar group, covering about 910 sq km, while **Indira Point** on this island marks the **southernmost point of India**.
- The islands are home to **five Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs)** : Great Andamanese, Jarwa, Onge, Shompen, and Sentinelese.
- The region is known for its **rich biodiversity, including tropical rainforests, mangroves , coral reefs** , and endemic flora and fauna species, and is also important for tourism activities such as eco-tourism and scuba diving.
- The islands hold major strategic significance due to their proximity to the **Strait of Malacca**, one of the world's busiest maritime trade routes, and host India's only integrated tri-service command.



India's Dual-Track Sports Policy for Pakistan



Source: IE

India has formally institutionalized a **dual-track sports policy** that maintains a strict freeze on **bilateral engagements** with Pakistan while ensuring full compliance with **multilateral sporting commitments** (ICC, IOC, etc.) hosted in India or abroad.

- **Safeguarding Athlete Interests:** By following the "practices of international sports bodies," the policy prevents **Indian athletes** from being disadvantaged or disqualified due to geopolitical friction.
- **Formalization of Ad Hoc Practices:** The memo transitions the handling of **Pakistan-origin athletes** and officials from an unpredictable case-by-case basis to a structured, transparent regulatory framework.
- **Supportive Visa Regime:** To meet **international norms**, the government has simplified the **visa process** for athletes, technical personnel, and officials, including **multi-entry visas** for international federation representatives for up to 5 years.

Significance

- **Olympic and Global Ambitions:** This shift is critical for India's bids to host the **2030 Commonwealth Games**, **2036 Olympics** (India has made an aggressive pitch to host it), and **2038 Asian Games**, where **inclusive participation** is a prerequisite for host city selection.
- **Impact on Near-Term Fixtures:** The policy paves the way for high-stakes encounters in the **Cricket Champions Trophy in 2029**, **50-over World Cup in 2031**, and upcoming **FIH Pro League** and **Hockey World Cup** matches.

Read More: [India-Pakistan: Scope of Soft Diplomacy](#)

Prasoon Joshi Appointed Prasar Bharati Chairman



Source: TH

Recently, the Government of India appointed noted lyricist and writer **Prasoon Joshi as Chairman of Prasar Bharati** , marking a key leadership change in public broadcasting.

- **About:** Prasar Bharati is a **statutory autonomous** public service broadcaster established under the **Prasar Bharati Act, 1990** , and became operational in 1997.
 - It functions under the **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting**.
- **Components:** Prasar Bharati comprises Akashvani (All India Radio), one of the world's largest radio networks, and Doordarshan, India's national television broadcaster.
- **Functions:** It functions as **India's national public broadcasting organisation** with the mandate of providing information, education, and entertainment services.
- **Initiatives:** Prasar Bharati has also launched **Waves OTT platform** for strengthening free-to-air OTT services in the spirit of public broad casting.



Read more: [Broadcasting only through Prasar Bharati](#)